Earth and Planets · Tier Pack · Aspire

Learning goal: I can describe the Sun, Earth, and Moon as spheres and explain what orbits what in our solar system.

Aspire Route (Book First)

Explain two pieces of evidence that Earth is spherical and explain why poster diagrams of the solar system are not drawn to scale.

Help: Evidence includes __ and __. Posters are not to scale because the Sun is over __ times wider than Earth and the distances are vast.

Optional Make It · Aspire

Make a Scale Critique Card

Compare the real diameters (Sun ~1,392,000 km, Earth ~12,742 km, Moon ~3,474 km) and explain why classroom posters cannot show size and distance to the same scale.

Word Help

sphere: a round 3D ball shape, like the Sun, Earth, and Moon

orbit: the curved path one object in space takes around another because of gravity

solar system: the Sun and the eight planets (plus moons and rocks) that orbit it

star: a giant ball of hot glowing gas that makes its own light, like our Sun

Exit Check

What 3D word describes the shape of the Sun, Earth, and Moon?

List the first four planets in order from the Sun.

Explain what the Earth orbits and what the Moon orbits.